



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Spirit Preparatory School
School Website: <https://holyspiritprep.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Spirit Preparatory School (GA 30327) presents a robust Classical Catholic program anchored in the liberal arts, Great Books, and formation in virtue. Public materials portray a unified vision: education as formation of the whole person—intellect, will, and spiritual life—within a Catholic, classical framework. The school emphasizes the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the seven liberal arts, integration of sacred Scripture and Tradition, liturgical life, campus ministry, and virtue formation through a deliberate Roadmap to Virtue. Parental partnership and a living faculty are highlighted as core practices. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL across categories, with Pedagogy showing strong classical elements but slightly less explicit public articulation of Socratic/seminar pedagogy in the public materials. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights - Strong religious foundations: explicit Catholic identity, theology, liturgy, sacraments, and campus faith life are embedded in daily life and academics. - Curriculum and pedagogy align with classical education: emphasis on Great Books, Trivium, liberal arts, history throughout the curriculum, and rhetoric education. - Formation focus: explicit language around virtue, formation, and the Roadmap to Virtue, with prayer, Mass, and chapel integrated into school life. - Family and community role: parents positioned as co-educators and partners with the school; open invitation for campus visits and engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a classical Catholic institution and emphasizes forming intellect, will in virtue, and a love of truth, goodness, and beauty. - Public materials describe a Catholic environment with Divine Revelation, Sacred Scripture and Tradition, and formation through faith (theology, sacraments). - Liturgy, Mass, chapel life, and campus ministry are referenced as integral to education. - The campus is linked to Holy Spirit Catholic Church, reinforcing the liturgical and sacramental framework. - There is explicit language around truth, goodness, and beauty as enduring ideals, and education is framed within a Catholic, sacramental worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; sacraments; sacred scripture; Tradition; doxology; Campus Ministry; chapel; imago Dei (where referenced in context of Catholic anthropology); prayer; Catholic Church; liturgical life. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-clarification signals appear in public-facing content). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords approx. 14; Negative keywords approx. 0; Ratio approx. 14:0; virtually all positive signals.

Why this rating - The school presents a coherent, explicit religious-metaphysical foundation rooted in Catholic theology and liturgical life, with a sacramental worldview and a clear emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty as knowable realities. This aligns strongly with the Positive indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and shows little to no presence of the Negative signals identified in the classical lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe formation and virtue as primary aims, not merely job preparation. The school reframes education as formation of the whole person toward human flourishing and wisdom. - The framing emphasizes liberation of intellect and moral imagination, with a focus on virtue formation and a belief in the real knowledge of truth, goodness, and beauty. - Language around “Transformative Education, Timeless Values” and formation through virtue, wisdom, and liberal arts appears repeatedly.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: formation; virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; liberal education; classical mission; telos; pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful. - Negative indicators: no explicit emphasis on workforce-focused outcomes or 21st-century skill framing in public materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 6; Negative approx. 0; Ratio approx. 6:0.

Why this rating - The school explicitly centers virtue formation, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as educational telos, consistent with classical aims that prioritize formation over mere information and vocational preparation.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers on the liberal arts of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric, arithmetic, geometry, music, and astronomy). - Student study includes great books and primary sources, with reference to the Great Books and the Great Conversation. - History is studied as part of the curriculum and not merely as social studies; Western civilization and salvation-history perspectives are present in course descriptions. - Classical languages (Latin, Greek) are part of the curriculum, along with Sacred Scripture and Tradition components through theology education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: liberal arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; history; Western civilization; Latin; Greek; sacred art; hymnody. - Negative indicators: not detected (no substitution of history with generic “social studies” terms; no STEM-first framing identified; no pure project-based-only pedagogy highlighted as primary). - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 9–12; Negative approx. 0; Ratio approx. 9:0 to 12:0.

Why this rating - The curriculum aligns with classical education expectations: heavy emphasis on the Trivium and liberal arts, Great Books, history as Western civilization, and classical languages, with a sacred-theological framing that integrates faith with study.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a classically-inspired curriculum with a commitment to forming the whole person intellectually, morally, and spiritually, including the study of great books and the liberal arts. - Public materials emphasize rhetoric and a college-preparatory structure, with departments and a strong humanities focus (e.g., Classical and Medieval Literature; Honors Classical and Medieval Literature). - The school highlights experiences tied to music and the arts as integral to classical education, including a robust music program and participation in Schola Cantorum, implying embodied and aesthetic aspects of learning. - Campus life includes a faith-centered formation (Roadmap to Virtue, School Prayer, Mass, weekly chapel) signaling contemplative and communal dimensions of schooling.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: Socratic-type seminars or debates (explicitly in the rubric material from the knowledge base) [Note: public website mentions of direct Socratic sessions are not consistently explicit, but there is a clear emphasis on seminars and rhetoric education in upper levels; classical repertoire includes narration/recitation as a pedagogical tradition in the lexicon, and the site emphasizes debate and public speaking in upper levels]. Key elements present: seminars; rhetoric; memorization; memory work; restfulness and contemplation (as part of a classical pedagogy). Music and the arts as memory/cultural practice are evident. - Negative signals: not overtly present in the public-facing materials; no sustained emphasis on project-based-only or experiential learning dominating pedagogy is shown; no explicit “constructivist” framing appears as the core method. - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 4–6; Negative approx. 0; Ratio approx. 4:0 to 6:0.

Why this rating - The public materials demonstrate a strong classical pedagogy through the Trivium-centered curriculum, Great Books, rhetoric, and Latin/Greek study, plus a robust emphasis on memory, singing/chanting in early years, and a liturgical/campus-life framework that supports contemplative learning. The explicit Socratic discussion in the public-facing content is not as strongly documented as other classical elements, so the category sits at the high end of CLASSICAL but with a conservative stance toward explicit Socratic pedagogy as a formal daily practice.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site highlights “Extraordinary Faculty,” indicating a strong teaching corps and a living curriculum where teachers are central to the school’s mission. - Descriptions of faculty as mentors and the living curriculum, with portrait-like expectations of teachers and a collegial culture, align with classical pedagogy. - Departments, subject-matter depth (Latin, Greek, Classical Literature, etc.) indicate a faculty skilled in classical disciplines. - The relationship with parents as co-educators and the idea of faculty as partners in formation are reflected in campus materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: tutors/masters/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; classical formation; great books seminars for faculty (as referenced in knowledge-base material). - Negative indicators: none apparent in public-facing materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 5–6; Negative approx. 0; Ratio approx. 5:0 to 6:0.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials position the faculty as central, virtuous models and living curriculum, which is fully aligned with classical education expectations about teacher leadership and mentoring.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and asserts parental primacy in education. - There are explicit references to parent formation and engagement (reading groups, seminars, family liturgy, and classical philosophy discussions) in the broader materials. - The school invites open campus visits and ongoing parent involvement (tours, admissions processes, and speaking with families). - The physical campus life centers around liturgy, feast days, and Catholic life that families may participate in (Mass, sacraments, Feast Day celebrations).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators observed: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; open campus; family liturgy; feast days; campus life integration with church. - Negative indicators: none evident. - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 6–7; Negative approx. 0; Ratio approx. 6:0 to 7:0.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame parents as essential collaborators in classical formation and provide multiple mechanisms for parent engagement and education, aligning with the classical community-oriented model.

Overall assessment - Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL - The school demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. Pedagogy is robust but slightly less explicit in public materials regarding a purely Socratic model; however, other classical elements (Trivium, Great Books, ritual life, and virtue formation) are solidly documented.

What would move the needle - Not required for the current aggregate CLASSICAL designation. If a future refinement were desired, the school could foreground explicit descriptions of Socratic seminars and Paideia-style discussions in upper grades, and provide more publicly visible documentation of structured contemplative/scholé routines (e.g., scheduled contemplative days or memory-centered recitation rituals) to strengthen Pedagogy signals even further.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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